



fellows fellowssc <fellows@science-corps.org>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Maria Niculescu-Duvaz

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

Thu, Jul 30, 2020 at 10:38 AM

To: fellows@science-corps.org

Name

Maria Niculescu-Duvaz

Gender

Female

Nationality

United Kingdom

Emailmaria.niculescu-duvaz.13@ucl.ac.uk**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

March 2021

City, state, and country of residence

London, UK

University educationPhD | Astrophysics | University College London | Sept 2017-
1st Class MSci | Astrophysics | University College London**What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)**

This looks like an amazing opportunity for me to get some experience in teaching and to inspire the younger generation, as working in education is my long-term career goal. I am really passionate about coming up with new ways to communicate physics to a variety of audiences, which to be honest I enjoy more than my actual research! I have dedicated a lot of my spare time to learning and experimenting with the best ways to do this. My experience in outreach has instilled in me a strong sense of the injustice in the schooling systems that are in place in the UK, which are even more present globally. I hope to contribute to equalising the playing field for kids as much as I can in my life. I often choose to work with underfunded

schools when I can, as I love to help underprivileged kids realise their potential and boost their confidence in their abilities. I have a yearning to share my knowledge and passion about the Universe with as many people as possible, and I find this especially rewarding with children, as if they are communicated with in the right way they can show so much wonder and curiosity.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

I have been heavily involved in the ORBYTS scheme and with outreach in my department more generally from the onset of my PhD. Through ORBYTS, I undertook cutting-edge scientific research with pupils in schools, after which students presented their research findings at an ORBYTS conference. For the first year we carried out a project where students scheduled telescope observations to observe exoplanet transits, after which we analysed them. For the next two years I designed a research project based on my own research, which involved adapting the code I use for my research into an easily useable app form, which the students used to create models of the cosmic dust and gas in supernova remnants, and obtained results which I aim to publish in a scientific journal and credit them. I have extensive experience with designing workshops and exhibits based around my research, as well as in giving engaging outreach talks, to a wide range of audiences. One example is my collaboration with the Virtual reality department in UCL to create an app where people can view the remnants of exploded stars in 3D with a virtual reality headset, which I have exhibited at several science festivals to schoolchildren.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

In science education
In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (2 year) and long-term (10 year) future (max. 200 words)

In 2 years I hope to secure a permanent job in the outreach sector, whether that be as part of helping to develop educational software on the more technical side, or as a communicator creating and delivering interactive sessions to a wide range of audiences, as I really enjoy both of these. I'd love to work as an outreach officer for a university, or for an institutional heavyweight like the Wellcome Collection or the Institute of physics, where I can begin to contribute to spreading Physics knowledge and engagement with as many people as possible through fun and engaging ways.

In 10 years I hope to see a tangible difference that I have helped create, in whatever institution or company I end up working, to children from marginalised backgrounds, whether that be through being one of the creators of a new piece of software that schools all over the world end up implementing, or by helping to establish a longitudinal educational scheme with underfunded schools, like ORBYTS, which would couple schools with researchers in Universities.

CV/Resumé

[CV_mnd.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

A friend or colleague

Any extra comment or message.

Desired start date would be March/April 2021, and I would be happy with any location, although Philippines is a slight preference, (and I would be happy to work on the scheme in other countries if you start up in them by then)

Sent from Science Corps